

SUGUMAN BANSAL

Assistant Professor
School of Computer Science
Georgia Institute of Technology

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RESEARCH INTEREST

Integration of Formal Methods and Artificial Intelligence for principled development of Safe AI

EMPLOYMENT

Assistant Professor in SCHOOL OF COMPUTER SCIENCE Jan. 23 - Present
Georgia Institute of Technology, Atlanta, GA

NSF/CRA Computing Innovation Postdoc. in COMPUTER AND INFORMATION SC. July. 20 - Aug. 22
University of Pennsylvania, Philadelphia, PA
Mentor: Prof. Rajeev Alur

EDUCATION

PhD in COMPUTER SCIENCE, **Rice University**, Houston, TX Sept. 16 - June 20
Thesis: [Automata-Based Quantitative Verification](#)
Advisor: Prof. Moshe Y. Vardi

MS in COMPUTER SCIENCE, **Rice University**, Houston, TX Aug. 14 - Sept. 16
Thesis: [Algorithmic Analysis of Regular Repeated Games](#)
Advisor: Prof. Swarat Chaudhuri

BSc (with Honors) in MATHEMATICS and COMPUTER SCIENCE Aug. 11 - May 14
Chennai Mathematical Institute (CMI), Chennai, India

SELECTED AWARDS, HONORS, AND FUNDING

CACM Article: Research and Advances on *Specification-Guided RL* [link] Feb. 2026, Vol. 69 No. 2.

Best Paper Award, ATVA 2023 2023

Invited Tutorial at 28th Joint Conference on ETAPS 2025 May 25

Keynote Speaker at Workshop on Verification of Probabilistic Programs (VeriPoP) 2026 July 26

Keynote Speaker at 44th Conference on FSTTCS 2024 Dec. 24

Keynote Speaker at 29th Symposium of Static Analysis (SAS) 2022 Dec. 22

MIT EECS Rising Star Awarded by the CRA and NSF for postdoctoral research 2021, 2018

FUNDING

- **(Federal Grant) NSF:** Formal Reasoning of Reinforcement Learning Policies (USD 600K) 2026-30
Sole PI, Award Number: 2619180, Award Announcement [here](#)
- **(Industry Grant) Amazon Research Award** (USD 40K Cash + USD 20K AWS Credits) 2025
- **IIT-Bombay/GaTech Collaboration** (~ USD 12K) 2024

ALL PUBLICATIONS

Underlined names: Papers by students that I advise

[ArXiv/GenPlan 25] [Certification-Guided Evaluation of Reinforcement Learning Generalization](#)

Vignesh Subramanian, Djordje Zikelic, Suguman Bansal

[GenPlan 25] AAAI 2025 Workshop on Generalization in Planning

[ArXiv] [Decoupled Behavior-Cloning for Scalable Inductive Generalization in Reinforcement Learning from Specifications](#)

Vignesh Subramanian, Subhajit Roy, Suguman Bansal

[ICML 26] [Reinforcement Learning for Reachability: Guaranteeing Asymptotic Optimality](#)

Amogh Palasamudram, Jakub Svoboda, Krishnendu Chatterjee, Suguman Bansal

In Proc. of International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML) 2026

[CACM 26] [Specification-Guided Reinforcement Learning](#)

Kishor Jothimurugan, Suguman Bansal, Osbert Bastani, Rajeev Alur

Communications of the ACM (CACM) 2026, February 2026, Vol. 69 No. 2

[ATVA 25] [Inductive Framework for Generalization in Reinforcement Learning for Specifications](#)

Vignesh Subramanian, Rohit Kushwah, Subajit Roy, Suguman Bansal

In Proc. of International Symposium on Automated Technology for Verification and Analysis (ATVA) 2025

[GenPlan 23] NeurIPS 2023 Workshop on Generalization in Planning

[CAV 25] [INTERLEAVE: A Faster Symbolic Algorithm for Maximal End-Component Decomposition](#)

Suguman Bansal, Ramneet Singh

In Proc. of International Conference on Computer-Aided Verification (CAV) 2025

[NeuS 25] [Specification-Guided Reinforcement Learning \(Tutorial\)](#)

Kishor Jothimurugan, Suguman Bansal, Osbert Bastani, and Rajeev Alur

In Proc. of International Conference on Neuro-symbolic Systems (NeuS) 2025

[FMCAD 24] [DAG-Based Compositional Approaches for LTLf to DFA Conversions](#)

Suguman Bansal, Yash Kankariya, Yong Li

In Proc. of Formal Methods in Computer-Aided Design (FMCAD) 2024

[ICML 24] [Reinforcement Learning from Reachability Specifications: PAC Guarantees with Expected Conditional Distance](#)

Jakub Svoboda, Suguman Bansal, Krishnendu Chatterjee

In Proc. of International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML) 2024

[ATVA 23] [Model-Checking Strategies From Synthesis over Finite-Horizon Tasks](#)

Suguman Bansal, Yong Li, Lucas M. Tabajara, Moshe Y. Vardi, and Andrew Wells

In Proc. of International Symposium on Automated Technology for Verification and Analysis (ATVA) 2023

Best Paper Award at ATVA 2023

[ACM SIGLOG News 23] [Automata-Based Quantitative Reasoning](#)

Suguman Bansal

In ACM SIGLOG News, Volume 10, Issue 3, July 2023

[IJCAI 23] [Multi-Agent Systems with Quantitative Satisficing Goals](#)

Senthil Rajasekaran, Suguman Bansal, and Moshe Vardi

In Proc. of International Joint Conference on Artificial Intelligence (IJCAI) 2023

[CAV 22] [Specification-Guided Learning of Nash Equilibria with High Social Welfare](#)

Kishor Jothimurugan, Suguman Bansal, Osbert Bastani, and Rajeev Alur

In Proc. of International Conference on Computer-Aided Verification (CAV) 2022

[AAAI 22] [On Synthesis from Satisficing and Temporal Goals](#)

Suguman Bansal, Lydia Kavraki, Moshe Y. Vardi, and Andrew Wells

In Proc. of AAAI Conference on AI (AAAI) 2022

[Henzinger-60] [A Framework for Transforming Specifications in Reinforcement Learning](#)

Rajeev Alur, Suguman Bansal, Osbert Bastani, and Kishor Jothimurugan

In Proc. of Principles of System Design 2022

[SAS 22] [Specification-Guided Reinforcement Learning](#)

Suguman Bansal

In Proc. of Static Analysis Symposium (SAS) 2022

Keynote Speaker Address

[VSTTE 22] [Compositional Safety LTL Synthesis](#)

Suguman Bansal, Giuseppe De Giacomo, Antonio Di Stasio, Yong Li, Moshe Vardi, and Shufang Zhu

In Proc. of International Conference on Verified Software: Theories, Tools, and Experiments (VSTTE) 2022

[LMCS 22] [Comparator Automata in Quantitative Verification](#)

Suguman Bansal, Swarat Chaudhuri, and Moshe Y. Vardi

In Journal of Logical Methods in Computer Science (LMCS) 2022

[NeurIPS 21] [Compositional Reinforcement Learning from Logical Specifications](#)

Kishor Jothimurugan, Suguman Bansal, Osbert Bastani, and Rajeev Alur

In Proc. of Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) 2021

[CAV 21] [Adapting Behaviors via Reactive Synthesis](#)

Gal Araman, Suguman Bansal, Dror Fried, Lucas M. Tabajara, Moshe Y. Vardi, and Gera Wiess

In Proc. of International Conference on Computer-Aided Verification (CAV) 2021

[TACAS 21] [On Satisficing in Quantitative Games](#)

Suguman Bansal, Krishnendu Chatterjee, and Moshe Y. Vardi

In Proc. of Int. Conf. on Tools and Algorithms for the Construction and Analysis of Systems (TACAS) 2021

[AAAI 20] [Hybrid Compositional Reasoning for Reactive Synthesis from Finite-Horizon Specifications](#)

Suguman Bansal, Yong Li, Lucas M. Tabajara, and Moshe Y. Vardi

In Proc. of AAAI Conference on AI (AAAI) 2020

[POPL 20] [Synthesis of Coordination Programs from Linear Temporal Specifications](#)

Suguman Bansal, Kedar S. Namjoshi, and Yaniv Sa'ar

In Proc. of the ACM on Programming Languages (POPL), 2020

[CAV 19] [Safety and Co-safety Comparator Automata for Discounted-Sum Inclusion](#)

Suguman Bansal and Moshe Y. Vardi

In Proc. of International Conference on Computer-Aided Verification (CAV) 2019

[CAV 18] [Automata vs Linear-Programming Discounted-Sum Inclusion](#)

Suguman Bansal, Swarat Chaudhuri, and Moshe Y. Vardi

In Proc. of International Conference on Computer-Aided Verification (CAV) 2018

[CAV 18] [Synthesis of Asynchronous Reactive Programs from Temporal Specifications](#)

Suguman Bansal, Kedar S. Namjoshi, and Yaniv Sa'ar

In Proc. of International Conference on Computer-Aided Verification (CAV) 2018

[FoSSaCS 18] [Comparator Automata in Quantitative Verification](#)

Suguman Bansal, Swarat Chaudhuri, and Moshe Y. Vardi

In Proc. of Int. Conf. on Foundations of Software Science and Computation Structures (FoSSaCS) 2018

TUTORIALS

Specification-Guided Reinforcement Learning

- (INVITED) ETAPS 2025
- NeuS 2025 (written tutorial with Kishor Jothimurugan, Suguman Bansal, Osbert Bastani, Rajeev Alur)
- AAI 23 (co-presented with Rajeev Alur, Osbert Bastani, and Kishor Jothimurugan)

OPEN SOURCE TOOLS

Lisa | Github Link

Reactive synthesis for finite-horizon tasks and efficient DFA generation from logical formulas

[3rd place in LTLf Track of SYNTCOMP 2023](#) [Results]

DiRL | Github Link

Compositional reinforcement learning from temporal specifications

ADVISING

Current Students

PhD Students

- | | |
|--|-------------------|
| [1] Vignesh Subramanian (Georgia Tech) | Aug. 23 - Present |
| Thesis Topic: Generalizable Reinforcement Learning from Logical Specifications | |
| [2] Lu-Chin Chang (Georgia Tech) | Jan. 26 - Present |
| Thesis Topic: Model-free RL from Qualitative Specifications | |

Masters Students

- | | |
|--|-------------------|
| [3] Sankar Gopalkrishna (Georgia Tech) | Jan. 26 - Present |
| Thesis Topic: Formalization of RL Proofs | |
| [4] Krishaang Gupta (Georgia Tech) | Jan. 26 - Present |
| Project Topic: Natural Language to Formal Specification Conversion | |

Alumni

- | | |
|---|------------------|
| [5] Amogh Palasamudram, MS (Georgia Tech) | Aug. 25 - May 26 |
| • Next: Google (SWE, Bay Area) | |

- (ICML 2026): Reinforcement Learning for Reachability: Guaranteeing Asymptotic Optimality
- [6] Ramneet Singh, Undergraduate + Masters (IIT Delhi) April 23 - April 24
- Next: Predoctoral Fellow, Microsoft Research India
 - (CAV 2025) A Faster Symbolic Algorithm for Maximal End-Component Decomposition
 - Master's thesis: INTERLEAVE : An Empirically Faster Symbolic Algorithm for Maximal End Component Decomposition of MDPs (pdf)
- [7] Yash Kankariya, Undergraduate (Georgia Tech) April 23 - Dec 23
- Next: MS (with Research), Stanford University
 - (FMCAD 2024) DAG-Based Compositional Approaches for LTLf to DFA Conversions
 - (AAAI 24 Student Abstract) Decompositions in Compositional Translation of LTLf to DFA
 - Georgia Tech's President's Undergraduate Research Award (PURA) for Fall 2023
- [8] Aryan Saboo, Undergraduate (Georgia Tech) April 25 - Jan. 26
- Georgia Tech's UROP Summer Salary Support Award 2025
- [9] Kaushik Arcot, Masters (Georgia Tech) Jan 24 - July 24
- Next: Quantitative Research Associate, JP Morgan Chase (New York City)
- [10] Siddharth Meenachi Sundaram, Masters (Georgia Tech) Jan 24 - June 24
- Next: PhD Student, Georgia Tech

TEACHING

CS 8803. Formal Methods in Reinforcement Learning

Fall 25, Georgia Tech Overall Course Effectiveness 4.8/5, Overall Lecturer Effectiveness 5/5

CS 8803. Logic in Computer Science

Fall 26, Georgia Tech Upcoming

Fall 23, Georgia Tech Overall Course Effectiveness 4.4/5, Overall Lecturer Effectiveness 4.7/5

CS 4510. Automata and Complexity

Fall 25, Georgia Tech Overall Course Effectiveness 4.38/5, Overall Lecturer Effectiveness 4.62/5

Spring 24, Georgia Tech Overall Course Effectiveness 4.5/5, Overall Lecturer Effectiveness 5/5

Spring 23, Georgia Tech (Hon.) Overall Course Effectiveness 4.7/5, Overall Lecturer Effectiveness 4.7/5

(Anonymous) Student Testimonials

- "The best part, according to me, is that the instructor encourages participation. We spent as much time on a topic as was required to get the entire class up to speed, not what was allocated."
- "The amount of engagement in the class as well. Very open 2-way discussion between the professor and students. This made the course intellectually stimulating."
- "Lectures were exceptionally good, maybe the best I've taken here. I really enjoyed how the class took tangents to explore problems from different angles while still staying relevant."
- "The old school lectures were really interesting! Us bouncing back and forth to the teacher and seeing how our questions are reflected on the whiteboard."

- “The lectures were so good. Prof Bansal is a phenomenal lecturer and it was one of the only classes I’ve taken where I learned pretty much everything in class.”

OTHER AWARDS

Thank-a-Teacher Certificate

GaTech’s official certificate presented by individual students to show their appreciation to a teacher

- CS 4510 (Automata and Complexity) Fall 2025
- CS 8803 (Logic in Computer Science) Fall 2023

Future Faculty Fellow

2019

Awarded by the School of Engineering, Rice University

Rice Engineering Alumni Graduate Grant

2017

Awarded by the Rice Engineering Alumni to one graduate student each year

Gold Medal at the ACM Student Research Competition at POPL 2016

2016

Andrew Ladd Graduate Fellowship

2015

Awarded by the Rice CS Department and Ken Kennedy Institute for excellence in CS

CMI Undergraduate Scholarship

2011 - 2014

Awarded by CMI to undergraduate students for excellence in academics

KVPY Science Fellowship (Govt. of India)

2008

Awarded by the Ministry of Science and Technology, Govt. of India, for excellence in Basic Sciences

Travel grants

AAAI Scholarship (2020), SIGPLAN PAC Travel Grant POPL (2020), CAV Student Travel Fellowship (2019), Rice Dean’s Travel Award (2019), WiL SIGLOG/VCLA Travel Award (2019, declined), MIT EECS Rising Stars Travel Grant (2018), NSF-CAV/VMW Travel Grant (2015, 2018), ETAPS Student Scholarship (2018), Google Student Research Summit Travel Grant (2017), LMW-LICS Scholarship (2017, declined), CRA-W Grad Cohort Graduate Grant (2017), ACM SRC (POPL) Travel Grant (2016), MSR Faculty Summit Travel Grant (2016), Off The Beaten Track Travel Grant (2016), MSR Summer School Travel Grant (2012)

OTHER HONORS

- Invited to **Dagstuhl Seminar** on Automated Synthesis: Functional, Reactive and Beyond April 24
- Invited to **Dagstuhl Seminar** on Scalable Analysis of Probabilistic Models and Programs June 23
- Invited to **Simons Institute** for program on Real-Time Decision Making Spring 18
- Invited to **Google Student Research Summit 2017** Sept. 17
- Invited to **Dagstuhl Seminar** on Game Theory, AI, Logic and Algorithms March 17
- Invited to **MSR Faculty Summit 2016** July 16

RESEARCH VISITS

Nanyang Technological University (NTU) Singapore

June 25 - July 25

Visiting Faculty

Host: Prof. Luke Ong

National University of Singapore (NUS) Singapore

May 23

Visiting Faculty

Host: Prof. Umang Mathur

NOKIA Bell Labs, Murray Hill, New Jersey, USA

June 18 - July 18

Research Intern

Mentor: Dr. Kedar S. Namjoshi

Simons Institute, University of California - Berkeley, California, USA

March 18 - May 18

Visiting Graduate Student

Spring 2018 program on Real-Time Decision Making

NOKIA Bell Labs, Murray Hill, New Jersey, USA

June 17 - Aug. 17

Research Intern

Mentors: Dr. Kedar S. Namjoshi and Dr. Michael Emmi

RESEARCH TALKS

Model Checking Finite-Horizon Properties

Simons Workshop on “Synthesis of Models and Systems”

June 24

Dagstuhl Seminar on “Automated Synthesis: Functional, Reactive and Beyond”

April 24

PLSE Seminar, National University of Singapore (NUS)

May 23

Formal Reasoning in Reinforcement Learning: A Boon or Bane

[[INVITED](#)] Center of Signal Processing (CSIP), GaTech

Oct. 23

EECS, UC Berkeley

April 23

[[KEYNOTE](#)] Static Analysis Symposium (SAS) 2022

Dec. 22

Reinforcement Learning from Logical Specifications

[[KEYNOTE](#)] Workshop on Verification of Probabilistic Programs (VeriPoP) 2026

July 26

Centaur AI

Feb 26

[[INVITED](#)] College of Computing and Data Science, Nanyang Technological University

June 25

[[KEYNOTE](#)] Foundations of Software Technology and Theoretical CS (FSTTCS) 2024

Dec. 24

[[INVITED](#)] ActSynt@ECAI2024

Oct. 24

Dagstuhl Seminar on “Scalable Analysis of Probabilistic Models and Programs”

June 23

Department of Computer Science - IIT Delhi

Oct. 22

[[INVITED](#)] Workshop on Open Problems in Learning and Verification of Neural Networks

Aug. 22

Specification-Guided Policy Synthesis

Jan. 22 - April 22

[[INVITED](#)] Carnegie Mellon University, CISP Saarland, ETH Zurich, Georgia Institute of Technology, IST Austria, Max Planck Institute - SWS, National University of Singapore, New York University, Pennsylvania State University, Purdue University, Tufts University, TU Graz, University of Illinois - Chicago, University of Southern California, University of Toronto, University of Waterloo (ECE), Washington University at St. Louis, Yale University

Reactive Synthesis from Quantitative Constraints: An Automata Approach

[[INVITED](#)] IARCS Verification Seminar Series

Oct. 21

[[INVITED](#)] Workshop on Continuity, Computability, Constructivity: From Logic to Algorithms

Sep. 21

Compositional Reinforcement Learning from Logical Specifications

[[INVITED](#)] Sapienza University of Rome

June 21

Reactive Synthesis for Coordination

[INVITED] Simons Institute (UC Berkeley): Workshop on Synthesis of Models and Systems March 21

On Satisficing in Quantitative Games

Hebrew University June 21

[INVITED] Formal Methods Seminar, Ben Gurion University March 21

Designing Intelligent Machines Via Reactive Synthesis

[INVITED] Machine Learning Seminar Series, Rice University March 20

[INVITED] ICES, University of Texas at Austin Feb. 20

Nokia Bell Labs, Murray Hill Feb. 20

Department of Computer Science - IIT Delhi April 19

School of Computing, National University of Singapore April 19

Automata-Based Quantitative Reasoning

[INVITED] Department of Computer Science, University of Pennsylvania Jan. 20

Verification Seminar Series, University of Oxford Nov. 19

[INVITED] RiSE Seminar, IST Austria April 18

Comparators for Quantitative Verification

University of California, Berkeley April 18

Student Spotlight, Winter School in CS and Eng.on Formal Methods, IIAS, Jerusalem Dec. 17

[INVITED] Saarland University March 17

[INVITED] Dagstuhl Seminar on Game Theory in AI, Logic and Algorithms, March 17

Asynchronous synthesis: The Ugly, the Bad and the ?

Application Platforms and Software Systems Group, Nokia Bell Labs, Murray Hill July 17

Reasoning About Incentive Compatibility

[INVITED] Google Student Research Summit, YouTube Headquarters, San Bruno Sept. 17

Conference and Workshop Presentations

AAAI-SSS 2023, ATVA 2023, Highlights of Logic, Games, and Automata 2023, AAAI 2022, NeurIPS 2021, Highlights of Logic, Games, and Automata 2021, SYNT 2021, TACAS 2021, Highlights of Logic, Games, and Automata 2020, AAAI 2020, POPL 2020, CAV 2019, SYNT 2019, CAV 2018 (a), CAV 2018 (b), FoSSaCS 2018, Off the Beaten Track 2016, ACM Student Research Competition at POPL 2016

SERVICE

RESEARCH COMMUNITY

NSF Panel 2026 | 2024 | 2023

Organizing Committee

Co-Organizer. PLSEFM + AI Workshop at Georgia Tech, April 2026

Co-Organizer. QuantFormal: Formal Verification and Learning for Quantitative Systems @FSTTCS 2025

Co-Chair. AAAI Spring Symposium Series 2023: On the Effectiveness of Temporal Logics on Finite Traces

Co-Organizer. Verification Mentoring Workshop @ CAV 2021

Program Committee

2027 AAAI 2027

2026. AAAI 2026, ATVA 2026, CAV 2026, Nasa FM 2026, TACAS 2026

2025. AISTAT 2025, ATVA 2025, ECAI 2025, ICML 2025, GenPlan 2025

2024. AAAI 2024, CAV 2024, NeurIPS 2024, POPL 2024, TACAS 2024, Women in Logic (WiL) 2024

2023. AAAI 2023, CAV 2023, CONCUR 2023, ESOP 2023, Highlights of Automata, Logic, and Games 2023, Nasa FM 2023, NeurIPS 2023

2022. GandALF 2022, SYNT 2022

2021. IJCAI 2021, LAMAS&SR 2021, SPLASH SRC 2021, SYNT 2021

Journal Reviewer

2023 LMCS

2022. Foundations and Trends in TCS, Henzinger-60

2021. ACM ToCL, FMSD, JACM, LMCS

2020. Acta Informatica

Conference Reviewer

2023. FoSSaCS 2023, L4DC 2023 2021. FMCAD 2021, FOCS 2021 2020. CONCUR 2020, ICALP 2020, IJCAI 2020 2019. ISAAC 2019 2018. FSTTCS 2018, LPAR 2018 2017. CP 2017, TACAS 2017
2016. IJCAI 2016

Artifact Evaluation Committee 2021. CAV 2021, SAS 2021